

data safeguarding and even trading. While the last few years of success seen by companies like Bitcoin and Ethereum have convinced people about the merits of this technology, there have also been cases when people have lost millions because security levels of the tech leave much to be desired for. Here's a look at why this dynamic and rather interesting blockchain technology and its users might be posed with unique threats in the near future.

Is Blockchain One Giant Distributed Computer?

Every time you read about blockchain and how it works, one of the factors that jumps to the forefront is that the technology is dependent on a number of nodes that key in as well as save information at the same time. If your idea of how this works meant that all these nodes have a mutual relationship with each other, your idea isn't wholly accurate. In reality each node/computer downloads the same information and saves it in the same order. This means there is a lot of duplication, and this duplicated data stays for 'blocked' in this 'chain' for posterity. A large network of individuals/nodes accept that a transaction made is true and is verified. And furthermore all information about the said transaction will remain timestamped and tamper free on the chain that it is linked to.

Forever Is Costly:

Understanding how the blockchain works is important so that you can interpret one of its greatest flaws or drawbacks at the moment. Real estate, whether offline or online, has never come easy. By having to download all the information on a blockchain every single time, individual nodes are pressed for capacity. Take for instance Bitcoin, the largest company applying blockchain technology, perhaps the most popular of the lot too - currently their entire accumulated network history has crossed a cool 100 GB. Think about that. Even your costliest smartphones or cheaper laptops are going to get clogged with that kind of data on it. Bitcoin accumulated this data over a period of years. But to get a real picture of how problematic this issue can be, let's look at a newer entrant into this field. Ethereum is a relatively new company that has entered the business world with its promise of revolutionising the way smart contracts are built and worked upon. They have made quite a wave ever since their inception. Ethereum has already accumulated data north of 200 GB in a much shorter life span. Yep, you read it right. 200 GB. That's a lot of system space. Let's not even